

but adjusted the “purchase” price by the amount of the dividends received each year.

I stopped doing the adjusting when the imputed price had dropped to \$1.20 per share (didn’t want it to go below zero). The price is now about \$126, so this effectively meets your criterion of a 100-fold increase, even if the stock price itself has not gone up 100-fold. The stock actually was probably purchased by my Dad at a price close to the \$1 mark ... The total value is now over a quarter million.

I find these stories inspiring. I also like the homespun quality of the stories. The above letter writer is not a hotshot hedge fund manager. He’s just a normal guy who held onto a stock.

Here’s another one:

I am very interested in the coffee can scenario because my personal experience is that this is the only way I really make money.

I have two hits and one huge miss over the years that would have been coffee can type investments.

My first hit was a 200 share investment in a small startup called Micros Systems. I paid \$1.30 for the shares. It grew and split several times since I bought it in 1981 or 82 (something like that) and was purchased last year by a large tech firm. I received \$54,000 for my stock.

The second was \$3,500 in General Electric stock. ... I was an employee for 3 years and invested through payroll withholding which GE matched. That investment grew to over \$125,000. ...

The bottom line was buying and leaving it alone.

The one huge miss was Telefonos de Mexico. I bought 600 shares of this in 82 and sold it when it doubled. Boy was that a mistake.

If I had left it alone, well. ...

You would think this strategy would have greater appeal than it does.

After all, how many people want to spend a large part of their time following ticker symbols, anxiously watching blinking lights on a screen and following the ups and downs of the market?